

From Berlin to Your Inbox: Why I'm Starting Data Biz on Substack

Insights and strategies for leading data-driven business transformations—straight from the front-line.



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Over seven years ago, I started my data journey at Foodpanda in Hong Kong. The name stuck with me—熊貓 (Panda in Traditional Chinese) represents where it all began. That's why when I created my Medium publication [Data Panda](#), it felt like coming full circle. Fun fact: the idea to formalize this publication was also inspired by a friend I worked with back in my Delivery Hero days. Now, I'm bringing that same spirit to Substack under a new name: **Data Biz**. Here's why.

The Journey So Far

Who is this guy?

- From Hong Kong 🇭🇰
- In Berlin for 3+ years 🇩🇪
- Data guy 📈

○ Product Analytics in HelloFresh SE



Yeah, where Bruce Lee is from

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An old slide I built for an NGO during my HelloFresh days.

I have worked over seven years on the frontline with data-building teams, navigating organizational politics, and driving measurable business impact across multiple continents and industries. From Foodpanda in Hong Kong to Delivery Hero, HelloFresh, and Vestia Collective in Berlin, my focus has always been bridging the gap between raw data and business outcomes.

Living and working in Berlin has been a pivotal chapter in my journey. Here, I've had the privilege of meeting and collaborating with many outstanding data leaders and practitioners. The vibrant and diverse data community in this city has deeply influenced my perspective—showing me new ways to apply data strategy, promote innovation, and foster leadership.

But here's what I've learned throughout this journey: data is not just a technical problem. Strategic alignment and people leadership are the linchpins of success. As I shared once in Count.co's data leadership series:

“Data teams should act as sparring partners for the business. We are not just yes-men. We curate requests, challenge assumptions, and lead when it comes to turning data into action.”

Who This Is For

This newsletter is created for business leaders and executives,

data leaders, and senior analytics and data engineers—all navigating the increasingly complex terrain of data strategy and organizational impact.

Why Substack? Why Now?

Medium was a great platform for reflection and documenting my early learnings. But Substack allows me to:

- Go deeper on the strategic and leadership challenges that define success beyond the technical “how”
- Share candid perspectives on coaching teams, managing stakeholders, and balancing enablement with leadership
- Build a direct connection with a community serious about elevating the role of data in business

Benefit from more robust features to manage my content and engage my audience in a more interactive and meaningful way

What You Can Expect

This won't be another newsletter filled with ML jargon or just tech tutorials. Instead, expect:

- Strategic Insights: From data strategy and roadmaps to stakeholder management and organizational leadership—the core challenges shaping our effectiveness
- Real-World Lessons: More than seven years of practical experience building teams and delivering impact on the frontlines of data-driven businesses
- Modern Data Stack in Context: Tools like Snowflake, dbt, Looker

and Airflow explained not as silver bullets, but enablers with bigger organizational processes

- Business-First Thinking: Moving beyond dashboards, data pipelines, and engineering toolings to answer the key question: how do we create measurable business value with data?
- Career Growth: Guidance for BI analysts, analytics engineers, and data professionals aspiring to leadership roles, with focus on soft skills that truly matter

The Promise

I'm here to share what I've learned, what I'm continuing to learn, and what I wish someone had told me when I began my journey. Whether you are building your first team, scaling analytics capabilities, rethinking your data strategies—or if you're a BI analyst, analytics engineer, or data professional looking to break into a leadership role—this is for you.

I still firmly believe in the classic framework of People, Process, and Tools. Data isn't just technology. It's about people, strategy, and impact. Let's explore it together.

Welcome to **Data Biz** on Substack.





Jimmy Pang

Data Leader | Berlin

Former: Vestiaire Collective, HelloFresh, Delivery Hero, Foodpanda

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